

Even in case of private cloud, it is always suggested that you add your own layers of security on the servers for a highly secure system.

Cloud hosting has three basic service models:

- ▶ **Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS):** The hosting service provider/vendor is only responsible for the computing infrastructure and hardware.
- ▶ **Platform as a Service (PaaS):** The hosting vendor is responsible for hardware as well as the computing platforms such as OS, execution environment, web servers and database.
- ▶ **Software as a Service (SaaS):** With SaaS, the vendor is responsible for providing you access to on-demand software as a consumer. You don't have to worry about how the application is running. Examples include Google Apps, Office 365 etc.

There are numerous cloud hosting service providers and the choice of hosting service provider depends on various factors. At a glance pricing looks pretty much the same among all services but when you go into the details, you will find differences that may help you minimise costs with a particular service.

Major concerns while evaluating any cloud hosting service for you should be Auto-Scaling, Scalability, Elastic Storage, Maximum Uptime, Back up, Monitoring, Pricing and usability of the control interface. Support is another criterion if you are a start up and you don't have an entire team sitting on for solving hosting and sys admin issues.

By and large, Amazon EC2 is the most popular among start-ups with huge companies such as Netflix, Dropbox etc hosting all their servers with amazon. In this chapter, we discuss some popular cloud hosting service providers and what they have to offer.

AMAZON EC2

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Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud is a cloud hosting platform offered by Amazon through Amazon web services. Amazon EC2 provides a basic plan of 0.08\$ per hour and is based on IaaS (Infrastructure as a Service) model. It gives you a well laid out Control Panel, an API and both Command line and graphical user interfaces to manage and control your servers. The base plan offers 1.7 GB RAM, 1 EC2 Compute unit and 160GB of local storage with options of both subscription as well as pay as you go payment modes.

Amazon EC2 is feature -rich and has 99.9% guaranteed network availability. It allows you to set custom permissions, privacy settings, advanced